

Searching for silver linings

I'll be honest, I didn't think too much of this cover story idea when Jayesh first suggested it. There's nothing at all wrong with the idea of helping the world or even someone in your neighbourhood; nothing wrong at all...I just didn't think people (and by people, I mean you) would care.

It's a selfish world these days, and we see it all around us. We're all proud capitalists; survival of the fittest, why should I care if someone else is too lazy to study, or too dumb, and then can't get a good job to allow him the luxury of owning, say, an iPhone 6? Companies don't care about anything but their financial top and bottom lines, and people don't care about anything but themselves and their families.

Or so I thought.

For example, I hoped brands would help Jayesh and the rest of the team make the cover story's dream a reality, but I was also cynical, and warned them of the likely outcomes. Of course, no brand would outrightly say no to helping the needy – what kind of image would that portray of the brand? What would matter was their interest after more persistent follow-ups. Would they still be as committed?

As we're nearing the end of the month and this magazine has to go to print, I'm thrilled that every brand we've approached has committed their help, and very enthusiastically at that. It's almost as if they feel as strongly as we do about helping technology reach the needy in India. I've never been happier to have been so wrong about anything.

Further inside this magazine, you'll get details about this little project that's mainly being cared for by our Big Daddy (Jayesh), and I hope you'll pay great attention to it – not just for this month's issue, but for as long as you can possibly contribute.

I certainly hope you aren't as jaded and cynical as I was initially, because I really want to believe that it's not just the brands that Digit interfaces with, but also our community that genuinely wants to see a better, more tech savvy India.

However, it's not just hardware that can help. You can't throw phones, motherboards and CPUs at the problem and expect miracles. What our country needs at the moment is for people to start giving a damn about one another. How

do you show you care? You part with more than money, you impart knowledge, and give some of your time.

I realise that time is possibly way more precious than money to many of us, and that's why it's important that we give a little of that precious commodity as well. Don't just donate the hardware, find a child who's interested in technology and show him/her how to use the hardware you're donating. Volunteer to teach technology at government schools. Get creative and solve local problems in your area and help the needy around you – the country will automatically fix itself.

Even Digit – which is often everyone's best kept secret – is a way you can spread technology knowledge. Stop keeping it a secret and donate your collection to someone needy. The old issues may not be of much use, but you could donate the 2014 set to someone just beginning to get into technology. Buy them a subscription if you can afford it, share the Fast Track with someone looking to learn about one of the hundreds of topics we've covered, share the DVDs...there are so many ways.

Focus on what you can do and then do it, no matter how inconsequential it may seem. Whether or not you will change the whole world is unimportant, because you can change the world for a few people, and most importantly, you will change the world for yourself – there's no better feeling than helping someone, trust me.

Again, I urge you to not just keep it to yourself – if this issue inspired you to do some good, or even if you were already involved in an initiative, please share it with us at editor@digit.in. Perhaps your story can inspire more people and give them ideas about how to replicate what you did (or are doing) in their own locality or town.

Here's to silver linings – not only should we keep searching for them in our own lives, we need to become them for others. It's the only way to actually change the world. 



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and let me know your thoughts.